

Past Continuous for Background Description

Setting the scene

Name: _____

Date: _____

Rewrite the sentences using the Past Continuous to set the scene. Then answer the questions.

Opening paragraph

The night was cold. A thin fog was creeping along the harbour while fishermen were mending their nets. Somewhere, a bell was ringing, and a lone dog was barking at the shadows. Nobody noticed the stranger who was watching them from the end of the pier.

- 1 Find four verbs in the Past Continuous in the text.

- 2 Why does the writer use the Past Continuous to describe the scene?

- 3 Who was watching the fishermen?

- 1 The wind _____ (howl) while rain _____ (pound) the windows.

Past Continuous for Background Description

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Questions

1. was creeping, were mending, was ringing, was barking, was watching
2. To create atmosphere and show actions in progress.
3. A stranger.

Fill in

1. was howling / was pounding

Teacher's notes

Highlight the literary use of Past Continuous for atmosphere.